

Lining figures (the default) sit on the baseline at a uniform height:

123456789.

Old-style figures rise and fall like lowercase letters:

o123456789.

Old-style suits running prose — the year 1789 blends into the words around it.

Tabular figures share one width, so a right-aligned column lines up digit-for-digit; proportional figures are individually spaced:

Tabular	Proportional
1,111	1,111
8,080	8,080
9,999	9,999